



Alberta Public Health Disease Management Guidelines

Acute Severe Hepatitis of Unknown Origin in Children



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For further information on the use of this guideline contact:

Health.CD@gov.ab.ca

Health and Wellness Promotion Branch

Public Health and Compliance Division

Alberta Health

Acute Hepatitis (non A-E) | Alberta Health, Government of Alberta

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Case Definition⁽¹⁾

NOTE: Alberta Health will update this guideline as new information becomes available.

Probable Case

A person ≤ 16 years of age who presents with severe acute hepatitis since October 1, 2021 and requiring hospitalization,

AND

- With serum transaminase >500 IU/L (AST or ALT)

AND

- Excluding hepatitis caused or attributed to a hepatitis virus (A, B, C, D, E)^(A) or known or expected presentation of a drug or medication; a genetic congenital, or metabolic condition; an oncologic, vascular, or ischemia related condition; or an acute worsening of chronic hepatitis.

^(A) If hepatitis D or E serology results are pending or test was not done, but other criteria met, these can be reported as probable cases.

Reporting Requirements

Physicians

- **Alberta physicians^(B)** shall notify the Medical Officer of Health (MOH) in their zone of all probable cases within 48 hours of diagnosis (by phone, fax or email) and include:
 - Name;
 - Age;
 - Date of birth;
 - Gender;
 - Personal health number;
 - Laboratory report; and
 - Other relevant clinical/epidemiological information.
- **Alberta physicians^(B)** shall submit the [Acute Severe Hepatitis of Unknown Origin in Children Case Report Form](#) to the MOH within 7 days of initial diagnosis.

Alberta Health Services and First Nations and Inuit Health Branch

- The MOH/designate of the Zone where the case currently resides shall report all probable cases to the CMOH/designate within 48 hours by email and will include
 - Name;
 - Age;
 - Date of birth;
 - Gender;
 - Personal health number;
 - Laboratory report; and
 - Other relevant clinical/epidemiological information.
- The MOH/designate, shall submit the [Acute Severe Hepatitis of Unknown Origin in Children Case Report Form](#) by email or through another mutually agreed upon reporting system (e.g., CDOM) within 7 days of initial notification. Follow up should be done to determine the evolution of the case's clinical status and the final report shall be submitted within two weeks of discharge from hospital or resolution of the case status, whichever occurs first. Report under *Rare or Emerging Communicable Disease*.
- For out-of-province and out-of-country reports, the following information should be forwarded to the CMOH (or designate) within 48 hours of diagnosis and include:
 - Name;
 - Age;
 - Date of birth;
 - Gender;
 - Personal health number;
 - Laboratory report; and
 - Other relevant clinical/epidemiological information.

^(B) It is expected that this reporting would typically be done by a pediatric specialist in infectious diseases or hepatology following their investigations.

ANNEX A: Revision History

Revision Date	Document Section	Description of Revision
May 2022	Case Definition	• Interim case definition
	Reporting Requirements	• Reporting Requirements provided

References

1. World Health Organization (WHO). Multi-Country – Acute, severe hepatitis of unknown origin in children [Internet]. 2022 [cited 2022 May 5]. Available from: <https://www.who.int/emergencies/disease-outbreak-news/item/2022-DON376>